



Basic Emergency Care

Bleeding Control

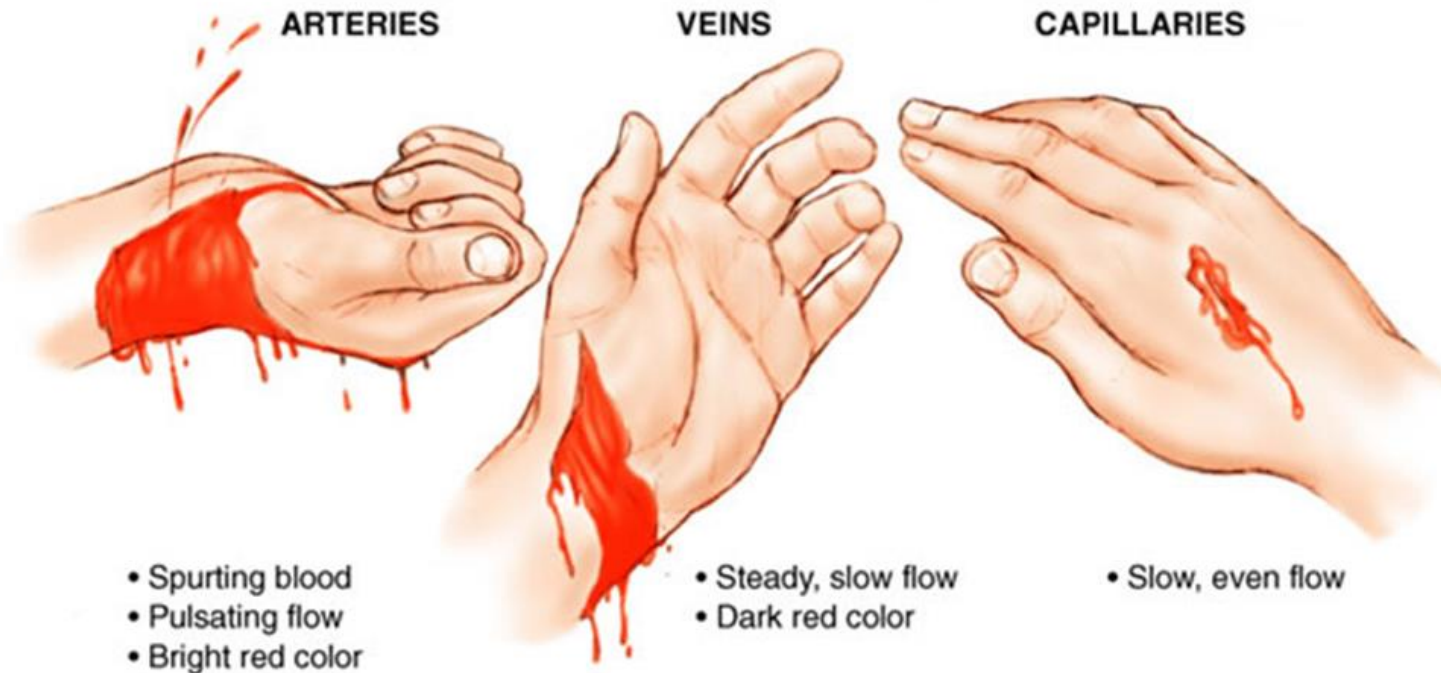
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INTRODUCTION

- While most people don't want to find themselves treating severe bleeding, you may need to learn how to stop blood loss in an emergency situation
- Unlike minor wounds, a severe wound may gush or spray blood. It may not clot as quickly and will need medical attention.

- Average adult body contains 5-6 liters of blood.
- Rapid loss of 1 L blood (1000cc) from adult can lead to shock and death.
- Rapid loss of 1-cup blood (250 cc) from child can be deadly.
- Rapid loss of 2-Tablespoons blood (30 cc) from infant can be deadly.

Types of bleeding according to the vessel :



Bleeding Classifications



According to site:

- External
- Internal
- Mixed



According to vessel:



- Arterial
- Venous
- Capillary



According to severity:

- Mild
- Moderate
- Severe

Steps of management

STEP 1: Keep calm.

- Dealing with severe bleeding can be shocking and stressful.
- While you wait for medical help to arrive, calm yourself by focusing on the steps necessary to stop the bleeding.
- Calm the injured person by talking to him or her, and giving assurance that help is on the way.
- ➤ Rescuer calmness prevents mistakes.

STEP 2 :Get help.

- Call for emergency medical help or ask someone else nearby to do it while you begin caring for the injured person.
- Call 122 (Hawler Emergency)
- ➤ Early EMS activation improves survival.

STEP 3: Make sure that there is no immediate danger of further injury.

- Do not move the injured person
- if there is immediate danger of other injury (from traffic, falling objects, etc.), try to form a barrier, keeping the injured person and others safe, such as by directing traffic around an accident site.
- • ➤ Rescuer safety is the first priority.

STEP 4: Help the injured person lie down, if the injury permits.

- Cover the injured person with a blanket or similar material to keep in body heat.
- Resting the injured person can help prevent him or her from going into shock.
- ➤ Preventing hypothermia reduces complications.

STEP 5: Wash your hands if possible:

- This will not only protect you from the risk of getting diseases, but also prevent the injured person from becoming infected
- ➤ Use gloves and mask if available.

STEP 6: Clear the wound site.

- If there is obvious dirt or debris in the wound, remove it if possible.
- However, do not try to remove large objects, or ones deeply embedded in the wound, since this can make bleeding worse.
- ➤ Embedded objects may be stopping bleeding.

STEP 7: Apply pressure.

- Use a sterile or clean cloth, gauze or pack and apply firm pressure directly on the site of the bleeding.
- Use your hands only if you have nothing else.
- Keep applying pressure without removing the cloth to check on the bleeding.
- If you take the gauze off, you could disturb clots that are forming to stop the bleeding.
- ➤ Continuous pressure forms stable clot.

STEP 8: Apply more dressing to the wound, if necessary .

- Don't remove the cloth covering the wound even if it soaks through with blood, as this can make the bleeding worse.
- You can place another layer of cloth , gauze or pack over the soaked one.
- The important thing is to keep applying pressure.
- ➤ Layered compression stabilizes bleeding control.

STEP 9: Secure the bandage.

- You can fix the bandage in place with tape, gauze strips or whatever you have on hand, like strip of cloth.
- Take care not to tie the strips too tightly, or you could cut off the circulation.
- ➤ Check distal pulse to avoid ischemia.



Gauze



Radiopaque Gauze



Pack



Place pad on wound

**Insert cloth leader
into pressure bar.**



**Pull and wrap in
opposite direction**

**Continue to tighten/
wrap bandage**



**Clip closure bar
onto bandage**

STEP 10: Elevate the injured part

- If a bone does not appear to be broken, raise the wound site so that it is above the heart.
- For instance, if a leg is injured, raise it on a chair or place a pillow under it.
- Elevating the wound can keep the blood from rushing , and intensifying the bleeding.
- ➤ Direct pressure remains the most effective measure.

STEP 11: Apply pressure to a pressure point if the bleeding does not stop.

- A pressure point is a location where you can squeeze an artery against a bone, which can slow the flow of blood.
- If the bleeding is near a leg, press and hold against the femoral artery in the groin, where the leg bends at the hip.
- If the bleeding is near an arm, press and hold against the brachial artery, along the inside of the upper arm
- ➤ Use when pressure is insufficient.

Management of Bleeding



1. Direct pressure stops most bleeding. Wear medical exam gloves, and place a sterile gauze pad or a clean cloth over wound.



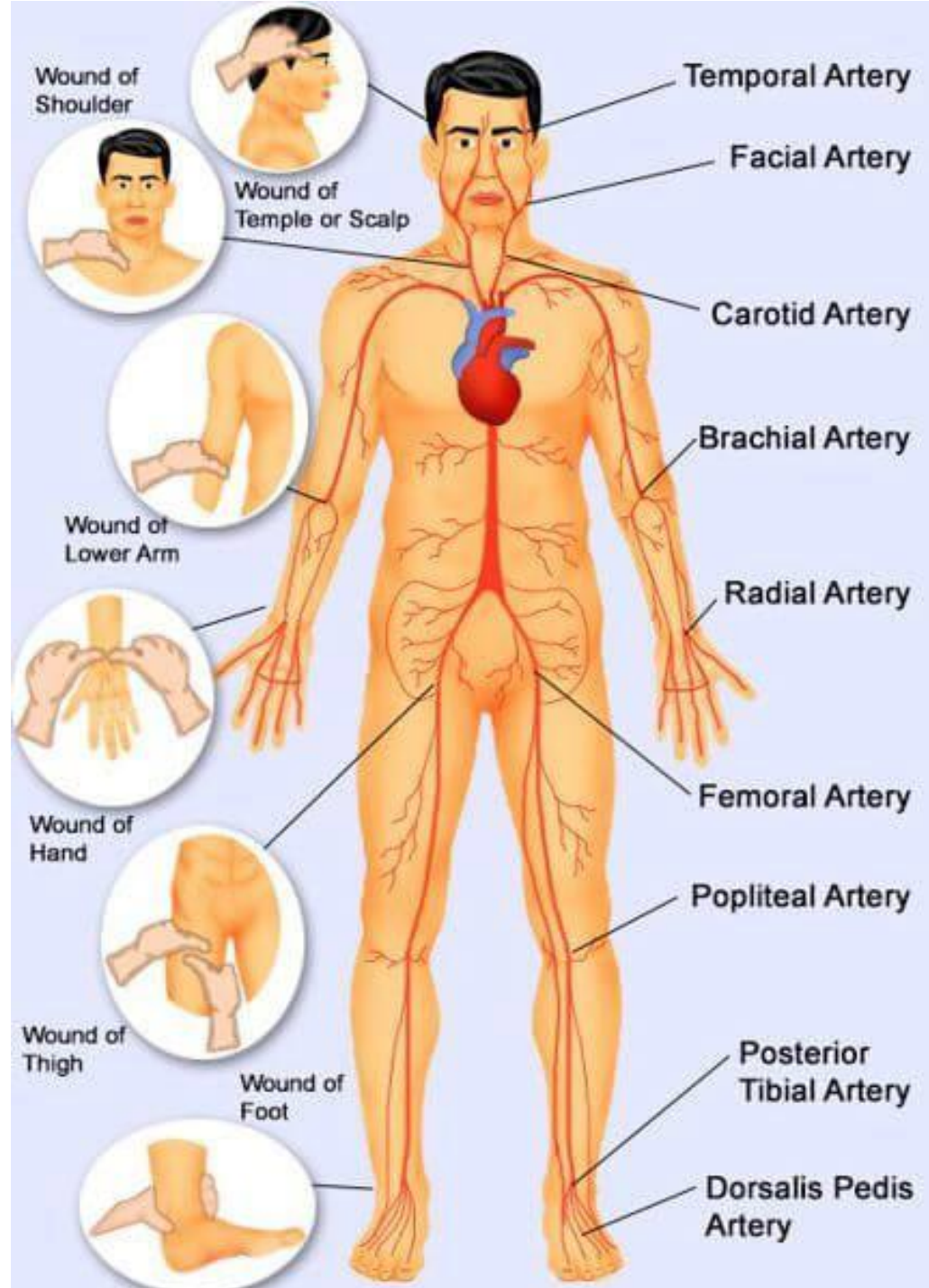
2. If bleeding continues, use elevation to help reduce blood flow. Combine with direct pressure over the wound.



3. If bleeding continues, apply pressure at a pressure point to slow blood flow. Locations are:



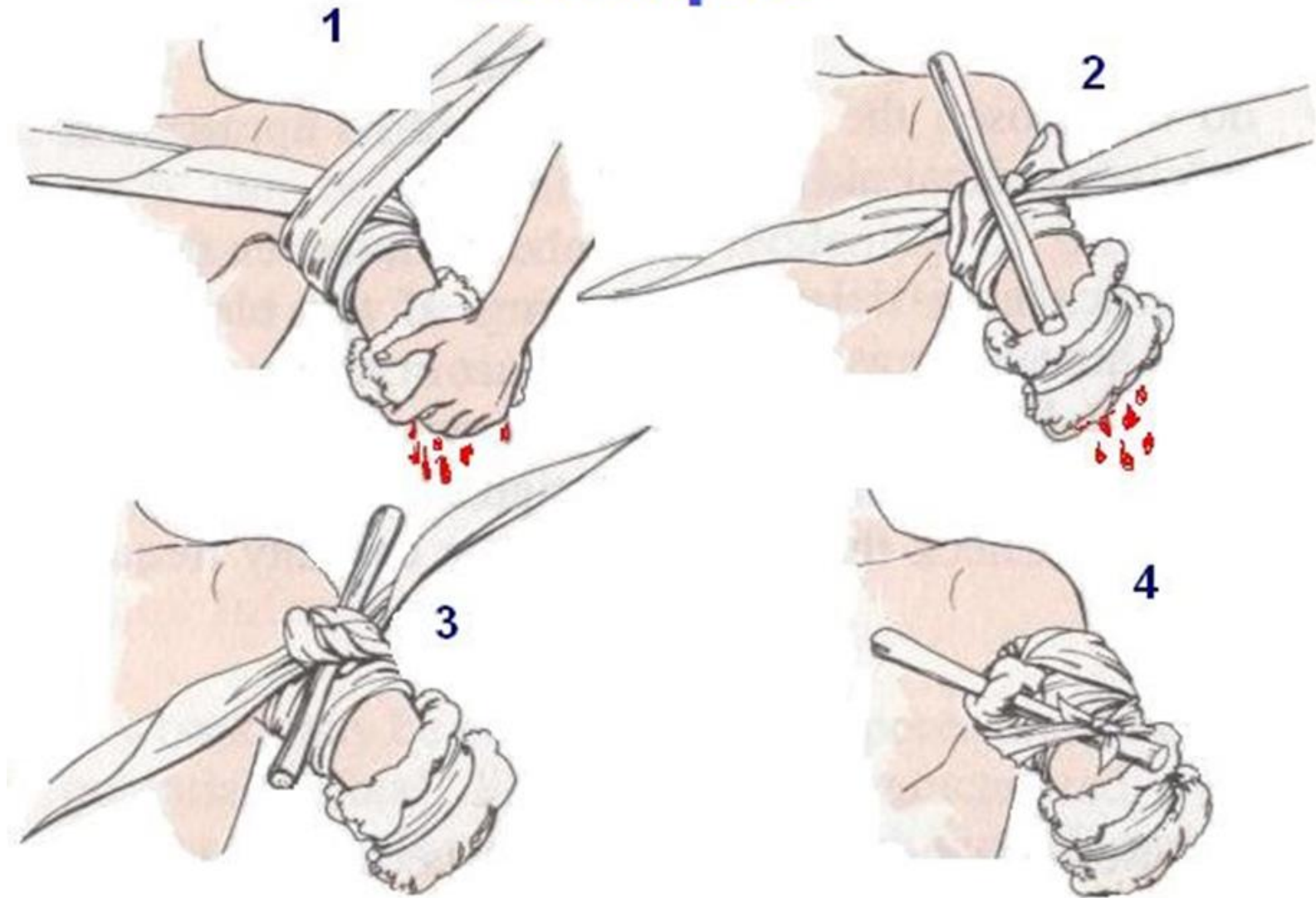
(a) brachial or (b) femoral. Combine with direct pressure over the wound.



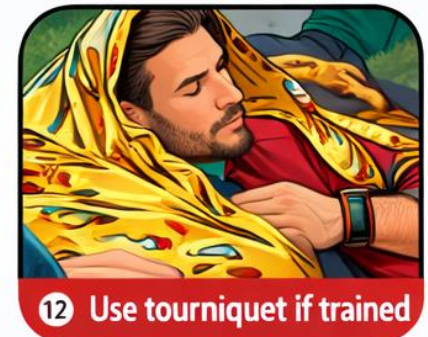
STEP 12: Use a tourniquet only if you have proper training.

- If bleeding does not stop, even after prolonged pressure, you may need to make a tourniquet
- Because there are severe dangers from incorrectly placing or applying a tourniquet, you should only use one if you've been trained to do so.
- ➤ Tourniquets save lives in severe limb bleeding. Record time of application.

Tourniquet



Steps in Bleeding Management



Recognizing Internal Bleeding

- • Pale, cold skin
- • Rapid weak pulse
- • Abdominal pain or swelling
- • ➤ Internal bleeding may not be visible.

Shock Prevention

- • Lay patient flat
- • Keep warm
- • Control external bleeding
- • ➤ Early shock management improves outcomes.

Red Flags – Immediate Transfer

- • Uncontrolled bleeding
- • Altered mental status
- • Suspected internal bleeding
- • ➤ Immediate hospital referral needed.